Architectures and service boundaries

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Sample chapter for the proposed course plan.

1 Learning outcome

Identify a service boundary and its communication costs.

Prerequisites: Lecture 01.

2 Core idea

Splitting an application into services introduces communication between independently running components. A useful boundary groups related responsibilities, but calls across that boundary add latency and new failure cases.

3 Worked scenario

The registration service asks a separate catalogue service whether a course exists. Catalogue unavailability can now affect registration.

4 Discussion

Which information could registration cache, and when would that cache become unsafe?

5 Recap

Service boundaries should be evaluated against both responsibilities and failure behaviour.